

Introduction to Multimedia Editing

Everyone today is a filmmaker. From videos taken at birthday parties to holiday trips, cell phone users produce more video footage per year than movie makers did in the first 50 years of filmmaking. However, given the awesomeness of the technology in their hands most users are still unfamiliar with how to edit the footage it creates. Combining all the different media created – songs, videos, text and effects – into a single polished product can truly make a difference to the quality of your memories.

The regrettable part is that editing is perceived to be such an elusive territory. Most users find it difficult to progress beyond automated movie making apps on their phones or at best applications such as Microsoft Movie Maker or iMovie to make cheesy looking videos. Well, worry not, for in this issue of Fast Track we address the entire spectrum of multimedia editing including audio and image files.

We'll journey into all the dimensions of editing and give you an overview of different types of editing tools and software options. The second chapter dissects the layout and workflow of any generic editing tool and explains the process behind the software. The third chapter in this Fast Track will show you what the professionals use and explains the powerful features of such tools.

The next three chapters are a catalogue of your free-to-use alternatives in case the professional tools are too intimidating or hard to obtain. We discuss dozens of applications that can help you get started with multimedia editing. Each chapter discusses the unique limitations and strengths of various mediums (be it desktop or mobile devices) and offers a variety of applications from which you can make the best suited selection. Some are more complicated than others, so there's something for every level of interest.